Specification of the controlled designation of origin "CORTON"

approved by decree no. 2011-1390 of 26 October 2011, JORF of 29 October 2011

CHAPTER I

I. – Name of the designation

Only wines meeting the specific provisions set out below may claim the controlled designation of origin "Corton", initially recognised by the decree of 31 July 1937.

II. – Geographical denominations and complementary terms

1° – The name of the controlled designation of origin may be followed by the term "grand cru".

2° – The name of the controlled designation of origin may be followed by the name of one of the following climats, for wines meeting the production conditions laid down in the present specification for the indication of one of these names:

- "Basses Mourottes";
- "Les Combes";
- "Clos des Meix";
- "Les Fiètres";
- "Hautes Mourottes";
- "Les Grandes Lolières";
- "La Toppe au Vert";
- "Les Grèves";
- "La Vigne au Saint";
- "Les Languettes";
- "Le Clos du Roi";
- "Les Maréchaudes";
- "Le Corton";
- "Les Moutottes";
- "Le Meix Lallemand";
- "Les Paulands";
- "Les Perrières";
- "Le Rognet et Corton";
- "Les Pougets";
- "Les Bressandes";
- "Les Renardes";
- "Les Carrières";
- "Les Chaumes";

- "Les Vergennes".

III. – Colour and types of product

CONTROLLED DESIGNATION OF ORIGIN, NAME OF CLIMAT	COLOUR AND TYPE OF PRODUCT
AOC "Corton"	Still white or red wines
AOC "Corton" followed by the name of one of the climats referred to in point II	Still red wines

IV. – Areas and zones in which the various operations are carried out

1° – Geographical area

The harvesting of the grapes, the vinification, the elaboration and the ageing of the wines are carried out within the territory of the following communes of the Côte-d'Or department: Aloxe-Corton, Ladoix-Serrigny and Pernand-Vergelesses.

2° – Delimited parcel area

a) – The wines come exclusively from vines situated within the delimited parcel production area as approved by the National Institute of Origin and Quality at the session of the competent national committee of 20 September 1984.

The National Institute of Origin and Quality lodges with the town halls of the communes referred to in 1° the graphic documents establishing the parcel boundaries of the production area thus approved.

b) – Where the name of the controlled designation of origin is followed by the name of one of the climats referred to in point II, the wines come exclusively from vines situated within the specific delimited parcel production area as approved by the National Institute of Origin and Quality at the sessions of the competent national committee of 20 September 1984.

The National Institute of Origin and Quality lodges with the town halls of the communes referred to in 1° the graphic documents establishing the parcel boundaries of the production area thus approved.

3° – Immediate proximity area

The immediate proximity area, defined by derogation for the vinification, the elaboration and the ageing of the wines, is made up of the territory of the following communes:

- Côte-d'Or department: Agencourt, Ancey, Arcenant, Argilly, Autricourt, Auxey-Duresses, Baubigny, Beaune, Belan-sur-Ource, Bévy, Bissey-la-Côte, Bligny-lès-Beaune, Boncourt-le-Bois, Bouix, Bouze-lès-Beaune, Brion-sur-Ource, Brochon, Cérilly, Chambolle-Musigny, Chambœuf, Channay, Charrey-sur-Seine, Chassagne-Montrachet, Châtillon-sur-Seine, Chaumont-le-Bois, Chaux, Chenôve, Chevannes, Chorey-lès-Beaune, Clémencey, Collonges-lès-Bévy, Combertault, Comblanchien, Corcelles-les-Arts, Corcelles-les-Monts, Corgoloin, Cormot-le-Grand, Corpeau, Couchey, Curley, Curtil-Vergy, Daix, Dijon, Ebaty, Echevronne, Epernay-sous-Gevrey, L'Etang-Vergy, Etrochey, Fixin, Flagey-Echézeaux, Flavignerot, Fleurey-sur-Ouche, Fussey, Gerland, Gevrey-Chambertin, Gilly-lès-Cîteaux, Gomméville, Grancey-sur-Ource, Griselles, Lantenay, Larrey, Levernois, Magny-lès-Villers, Mâlain, Marcenay, Marey-lès-Fussey, Marsannay-la-Côte, Massingy, Mavilly-Mandelot, Meloisey, Merceuil, Messanges, Meuilley, Meursanges, Meursault, Molesme, Montagny-lès-Beaune, Monthelie, Montliot-et-Courcelles, Morey-Saint-Denis, Mosson, Nantoux, Nicey, Noiron-sur-Seine, Nolay, Nuits-Saint-Georges, Obtrée, Perrigny-lès-Dijon, Plombières-lès-Dijon, Poinçon-lès-Larrey, Pommard, Pothières, Premeaux-Prissey, Prusly-sur-Ource, Puligny-Montrachet, Quincey, Reulle-Vergy, La Rochepot, Ruffey-lès-Beaune, Saint-Aubin, Saint-Bernard, Saint-Philibert, Saint-Romain, Sainte-Colombe-sur-Seine, Sainte-Marie-la-Blanche, Santenay, Savigny-lès-Beaune, Segrois, Tailly, Talant,

Thoires, Vannaire, Vauchignon, Velars-sur-Ouche, Vertault, Vignoles, Villars-Fontaine, Villebichot, Villedieu, Villers-la-Faye, Villers-Patras, Villy-le-Moutier, Vix, Volnay, Vosne-Romanée and Vougeot.

- Rhône department: Alix, Anse, L'Arbresle, Les Ardillats, Arnas, Bagnols, Beaujeu, Belleville, Belmont-d'Azergues, Blacé, Le Bois-d'Oingt, Le Breuil, Bully, Cercié, Chambost-Allières, Chamelet, Charentay, Charnay, Châtillon, Chazay-d'Azergues, Chénas, Chessy, Chiroubles, Cogny, Corcelles-en-Beaujolais, Dareizé, Denicé, Dracé, Emeringes, Fleurie, Frontenas, Gleizé, Jarnioux, Juliénas, Jullié, Lacenas, Lachassagne, Lancié, Lantignié, Légny, Létra, Liergues, Limas, Lozanne, Lucenay, Marchampt, Marcy, Moiré, Montmelas-Saint-Sorlin, Morancé, Nuelles, Odenas, Oingt, Les Olmes, Le Perréon, Pommiers, Pouilly-le-Monial, Quincié-en-Beaujolais, Régnié-Durette, Rivolet, Saint-Clément-sur-Valsonne, Saint-Cyr-le-Chatoux, Saint-Didier-sur-Beaujeu, Saint-Etienne-des-Oullières, Saint-Etienne-la-Varenne, Saint-Georges-de-Reneins, Saint-Germain-sur-l'Arbresle, Saint-Jean-d'Ardières, Saint-Jean-des-Vignes, Saint-Julien, Saint-Just-d'Avray, Saint-Lager, Saint-Laurent-d'Oingt, Saint-Loup, Saint-Romain-de-Popey, Saint-Vérand, Sainte-Paule, Salles-Arbuissonnas-en-Beaujolais, Sarcey, Taponas, Ternand, Theizé, Vaux-en-Beaujolais, Vauxrenard, Vernay, Villefranche-sur-Saône, Ville-sur-Jarnioux and Villié-Morgon.

- Saône-et-Loire department: Aluze, Ameugny, Azé, Barizey, Beaumont-sur-Grosne, Berzé-la-Ville, Berzé-le-Châtel, Bissey-sous-Cruchaud, Bissy-la-Mâconnaise, Bissy-sous-Uxelles, Bissy-sur-Fley, Blanot, Bonnay, Bouzeron, Boyer, Bray, Bresse-sur-Grosne, Burgy, Burnand, Bussières, Buxy, Cersot, Chagny, Chaintré, Chalon-sur-Saône, Chamilly, Champagny-sous-Uxelles, Champforgeuil, Chânes, Change, Chapaize, La Chapelle-de-Bragny, La Chapelle-de-Guinchay, La Chapelle-sous-Brancion, Charbonnières, Chardonnay, La Charmée, Charnay-lès-Mâcon, Charrecey, Chasselas, Chassey-le-Camp, Château, Châtenoy-le-Royal, Chaudenay, Cheilly-lès-Maranges, Chenôves, Chevagny-lès-Chevrières, Chissey-lès-Mâcon, Clessé, Cluny, Cormatin, Cortambert, Cortevaix, Couches, Crêches-sur-Saône, Créot, Cruzille, Culles-les-Roches, Curtil-sous-Burnand, Davayé, Demigny, Dennevy, Dezize-lès-Maranges, Donzy-le-National, Donzy-le-Pertuis, Dracy-le-Fort, Dracy-lès-Couches, Epertully, Etrigny, Farges-lès-Chalon, Farges-lès-Mâcon, Flagy, Fleurville, Fley, Fontaines, Fuissé, Genouilly, Germagny, Givry, Granges, Grevilly, Hurigny, Igé, Jalogny, Jambles, Jugy, Jully-lès-Buxy, Lacrost, Laives, Laizé, Lalheue, Leynes, Lournand, La Loyère, Lugny, Mâcon, Malay, Mancey, Martailly-lès-Brancion, Massilly, Massy, Mellecey, Mercurey, Messey-sur-Grosne, Milly-Lamartine, Montagny-lès-Buxy, Montbellet, Montceaux-Ragny, Moroges, Nanton, Ozenay, Paris-l'Hôpital, Péronne, Pierreclos, Plottes, Préty, Prissé, Pruzilly, Remigny, La Roche-Vineuse, Romanèche-Thorins, Rosey, Royer, Rully, Saint-Albain, Saint-Ambreuil, Saint-Amour-Bellevue, Saint-Boil, Saint-Clément-sur-Guye, Saint-Denis-de-Vaux, Saint-Désert, Saint-Gengoux-de-Scissé, Saint-Gengoux-le-National, Saint-Germain-lès-Buxy, Saint-Gervais-sur-Couches, Saint-Gilles, Saint-Jean-de-Trézy, Saint-Jean-de-Vaux, Saint-Léger-sur-Dheune, Saint-Mard-de-Vaux, Saint-Martin-Belle-Roche, Saint-Martin-du-Tartre, Saint-Martin-sous-Montaigu, Saint-Maurice-de-Satonnay, Saint-Maurice-des-Champs, Saint-Maurice-lès-Couches, Saint-Pierre-de-Varennes, Saint-Rémy, Saint-Sernin-du-Plain, Saint-Symphorien-d'Ancelles, Saint-Vallerin, Saint-Vérand, Saint-Ythaire, Saisy, La Salle, Salornay-sur-Guye, Sampigny-lès-Maranges, Sancé, Santilly, Sassangy, Saules, Savigny-sur-Grosne, Sennecey-le-Grand, Senozan, Sercy, Serrières, Sigy-le-Châtel, Sologny, Solutré-Pouilly, Taizé, Tournus, Uchizy, Varennes-lès-Mâcon, Vaux-en-Pré, Vergisson, Vers, Verzé, Le Villars, La Vineuse, Vinzelles and Viré.

- Yonne department: Accolay, Aigremont, Annay-sur-Serin, Arcy-sur-Cure, Asquins, Augy, Auxerre, Avallon, Bazarnes, Beine, Bernouil, Béru, Bessy-sur-Cure, Bleigny-le-Carreau, Censy, Chablis, Champlay, Champs-sur-Yonne, Champvallon, Chamvres, La Chapelle-Vaupelteigne, Charentenay, Châtel-Gérard, Chemilly-sur-Serein, Cheney, Chevannes, Chichée, Chitry, Collan, Coulangeron, Coulanges-la-Vineuse, Courgis, Cravant, Cruzy-le-Châtel, Dannemoine, Dyé, Epineuil, Escamps, Escolives-Sainte-Camille, Fleys, Fontenay-près-Chablis, Gy-l'Evêque, Héry, Irancy, Island, Joigny, Jouancy, Junay, Jussy, Lichères-près-Aigremont, Lignorelles, Ligny-le-Châtel, Lucy-sur-Cure, Maligny, Mélisey, Merry-Sec, Migé, Molay, Molosmes, Montigny-la-Resle, Mouffy, Moulins-en-Tonnerois, Nitry, Noyers, Ouanne, Paroy-sur-Tholon, Pasilly, Pierre-Perthuis, Poilly-sur-Serein,

Pontigny, Préhy, Quenne, Roffey, Rouvray, Sacy, Saint-Bris-le-Vineux, Saint-Cyr-les-Colons, Saint-Père, Sainte-Pallaye, Sainte-Vertu, Sarry, Senan, Serrigny, Tharoiseau, Tissey, Tonnerre, Tronchoy, Val-de-Mercy, Vallan, Venouse, Venoy, Vermenton, Vézannes, Vézelay, Vézinnes, Villeneuve-Saint-Salves, Villiers-sur-Tholon, Villy, Vincelles, Vincelottes, Viviers, Volgré and Yrouerre.

V. – Grape varieties

1° – Grape varieties

a) – The white wines come from the following varieties:

- main variety: chardonnay B;

- accessory variety: pinot blanc B.

b) – The red wines come from the following varieties:

- main variety: pinot noir N;

- accessory varieties: chardonnay B, pinot blanc B, pinot gris G.

2° – Proportion rules on the holding

Compliance of the planting is assessed, for the colour concerned, over all the parcels of the holding producing the wine of the controlled designation of origin.

a) – White wines:

The proportion of the pinot blanc B variety is less than or equal to 10 % of the planting.

b) – Red wines:

The accessory varieties are authorised only as mixed plantings within the vines. Their total proportion is limited to 15 % within each parcel.

VI. – Management of the vineyard

1° – Training methods

a) – Planting density

- The vines have a minimum planting density of 9,000 plants per hectare, with a spacing between rows less than or equal to 1.25 metres and a spacing between plants within the same row greater than or equal to 0.50 metre;

- The vines may be planted "en foule" (randomly, without rows), provided that the minimum planting density is respected and the spacing between plants is greater than 0.50 metre.

b) – Pruning rules

The wines come from vines pruned according to the following provisions:

COLOUR OF THE WINES	**PRUNING RULES**
GENERAL PROVISIONS	
White wines	The vines are pruned: – either short pruning (vines trained as Royat cordon and bilateral cordon), with a number of free eyes per plant less than or equal to 10; – or single Guyot long pruning, with a number of free eyes per plant less than or equal to 8.

COLOUR OF THE WINES	**PRUNING RULES**
Red wines	The vines are pruned with a maximum of 8 free eyes per plant: – either short pruning (vines trained as Royat cordon, bilateral cordon, gobelet and fan); – or single Guyot long pruning.
PARTICULAR PROVISIONS	
The period for establishing the cordon is limited to 2 years. During this period, double Guyot pruning, with a maximum of 5 free eyes on each cane, is authorised. Single Guyot pruning may be adapted: – with a 2nd spur allowing the position of the cane to be alternated from one year to the next; – with a cane shortened to a maximum of 3 free eyes and a spur limited to 2 free eyes. Whatever the pruning method, the vines may be pruned with additional free eyes provided that, at the phenological stage corresponding to 11 or 12 leaves, the number of fruit-bearing shoots of the year per plant is less than or equal to the number of free eyes defined in the pruning rules.	

c) – Trellising and foliage height rules

- The height of trellised foliage is at least equal to 0.6 times the spacing between rows, the height of trellised foliage being measured between the lower limit of the foliage, set at least 0.30 metre above the ground, and the upper trimming limit;

- When the vines are not trained in gobelet, they must be raised on a stake or trellised; the trellising is maintained;

- When the vines are planted "en foule", they are trained on stakes.

d) – Average maximum load per parcel

The average maximum load per parcel is set at:

- 9,000 kilograms per hectare for the white wines;

- 8,000 kilograms per hectare for the red wines.

e) – Threshold of missing vines

The percentage of dead or missing vine plants referred to in Article D. 645-4 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code is set at 20 %.

f) – Cultivation condition of the vine

The parcels are managed so as to ensure a good overall cultivation condition of the vine, in particular its sanitary condition and the upkeep of its soil.

2° – Other cultivation practices

a) – In order to preserve the characteristics of the physical and biological environment, which constitutes a fundamental element of the terroir, any substantial modification of the morphology, the subsoil, the arable layer or the elements that guarantee the integrity and sustainability of the soils of a parcel intended for the production of the controlled designation of origin is prohibited, with the exception of classic deep-ploughing works.

b) – Vine plantings and replacements are carried out with healthy plant material that has undergone hot-water treatment or any other method making it possible to combat flavescence dorée.

3° – Irrigation

Irrigation is prohibited.

VII. – Harvest, transport and ripeness of the grapes

1° – Harvest

a) – The wines come from grapes harvested at good ripeness.

b) – Particular provisions for transport of the harvest

The harvest is protected from rain during its transport and on its reception.

2° – Ripeness of the grapes

The sugar content of the grapes and the natural alcoholic strengths by volume of the wines meet the following characteristics:

COLOUR OF THE WINES	MINIMUM SUGAR CONTENT OF THE GRAPES (grams per litre of must)	MINIMUM NATURAL ALCOHOLIC STRENGTH BY VOLUME
White wines	195	12 %
Red wines	198	11.5 %

VIII. – Yields – Entry into production

1° – Yield and limit yield

The yield and limit yield referred to in Article D. 645-7 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code are set at:

COLOUR OF THE WINES	YIELD (hectolitres per hectare)	LIMIT YIELD (hectolitres per hectare)
White wines	48	54
Red wines	42	49

2° – Entry into production of young vines

The benefit of the controlled designation of origin may only be granted to wines coming from:

- parcels of young vines only from the 2nd year following that in the course of which planting was carried out in place before 31 July;

- parcels of young vines only from the 1st year following that in the course of which grafting in place was carried out before 31 July;

- parcels of vines that have been top-grafted, at the earliest in the 1st year following that in the course of which the top-grafting was carried out before 31 July, and once the parcels no longer contain any varieties other than those permitted for the appellation. By derogation, in the year following that in the course of which the top-grafting was carried out before 31 July, the varieties permitted for the appellation may represent only 80 % of the planting of each parcel concerned.

IX. – Processing, elaboration, ageing, packaging, storage

1° – General provisions

The wines are vinified in accordance with local, fair and constant usages.

a) – Blending of varieties

- The proportion of the pinot blanc B variety is less than or equal to 30 % in the blend of the white wines;

- Red wines produced from parcels with mixed plantings are vinified by blending the grapes.

b) – Malolactic fermentation

At the packaging stage, the red wines have a maximum malic acid content of 0.4 gram per litre.

c) – Analytical standards

Finished wines, ready to be released for consumption within the meaning of Article D. 645-18-I of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code, have a maximum fermentable sugar content (glucose + fructose) of:

COLOUR OF THE WINES	**MAXIMUM FERMENTABLE SUGAR CONTENT (glucose + fructose)**
White wines	– 3 grams per litre; – or 4 grams per litre if the total acidity is greater than or equal to 55.10 milliequivalents per litre, i.e. 4.13 grams per litre expressed as tartaric acid (or 2.7 grams per litre expressed as H2SO4).
Red wines	2 grams per litre

d) – Oenological practices and physical treatments

- Subtractive enrichment techniques (TSE) are authorised for the red wines within the limit of a concentration rate of 10 %;

- The use of pieces of wood is prohibited;

- After enrichment, the wines do not exceed a total alcoholic strength by volume of 14.5 %.

e) – Prohibited equipment

Continuous presses are prohibited.

f) – Vat capacity

Every operator has an overall vat capacity (vinification and storage) equivalent to at least:

- for the white wines, the volume of wine vinified for the previous year's harvest, as entered either on the harvest declaration, pro rata to the change in the holding's area in production, or on the production declaration;

- for the red wines, 150 % of the volume of wine vinified for the previous year's harvest, as entered either on the harvest declaration, pro rata to the change in the holding's area in production, or on the production declaration.

g) – Upkeep of the cellar and equipment

The cellar and the equipment are well maintained; this is reflected in particular by:

- general hygiene of the elaboration premises, with general cleanliness, well-maintained floors, adequate drainage and a surface avoiding stagnation;

- harmlessness of the equipment and products coming into contact with the wine;

- separation and specificity of the premises: premises without the same functions must be separated, such as storage areas for plant-protection products, cleaning products or hydrocarbons, from the premises for vinification, ageing and storage of dry goods (corks, cartons);

- management of wine effluents: effluents must be removed as quickly as possible from foodstuff premises and deposited in well-maintained containers that are easy to clean and can be closed; waste storage areas must be kept clean; waste must be disposed of hygienically and in an environmentally friendly manner; a waste storage and removal area must be provided;

- absence of hazardous or odorous substances in the vinification, ageing and storage premises (odour).

h) – Ageing

- The wines are aged at least until 15 June of the year following that of the harvest;

- The temperature of the containers during the ageing phase is controlled and less than or equal to 25 °C.

2° – Provisions relating to packaging

For every packaged lot, the operator keeps available for the approved control body:

- the information appearing in the register of handling operations referred to in Article D. 645-18 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code;

- the reports of analyses carried out before or after packaging.

These reports are kept for a period of 6 months from the date of packaging.

3° – Provisions relating to storage

The operator provides evidence of a protected storage place for wines packaged in unlabelled bottles, with a temperature of between 5 °C and 22 °C.

4° – Provisions relating to the circulation of products and placing on the market for the consumer

At the end of the ageing period, the wines are placed on the market for the consumer from 30 June of the year following that of the harvest.

X. – Link with the geographical area

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The geographical area is situated at the northern end of the "Côte de Beaune" vineyard. The "Côte de Beaune" is a linear relief of tectonic origin stretching in a general north-east/south-west direction. It separates the limestone plateaux of the "Hautes Côtes" to the west, at an altitude of between 400 metres and 500 metres, from the Bresse plain to the east, a Tertiary rift valley whose altitude, level with the "Côte", is close to 200 metres.

The climate is dominated by a cool oceanic tendency, disturbed by continental or southern influences channelled along the Rhône–Saône axis. The regional oceanic character shows in a moderate and regular rainfall regime (about 750 millimetres per year), with no marked summer drought. Temperatures show a certain coolness, with an annual average of 10.5 °C. The "Côte", east of the Morvan massif and the Burgundian plateaux, benefits from climatic shelter resulting in a thermal advantage as well as a rainfall deficit that is notable for the region.

The geographical area extends over the territory of 3 communes situated a few kilometres north of the town of Beaune, in the Côte-d'Or department, in Burgundy. Morphologically it corresponds to the slopes of the "Montagne de Corton", which stands as an isolated element of the "Côte", set apart between two valleys draining the hinterland.

The geological sequence on the slope is relatively complex, with outcrops of Jurassic sedimentary formations.

At the foot of the slope, the Middle Jurassic "Dalle nacrée" limestones, which split into slabs, the "laves", outcrop only a little, in a few old quarries. The limestones are masked by a layer of colluvium resulting from run-off along the slope. The soils are shallow and free-draining, although rich in clay, and sometimes very stony.

These limestones are overlain by an essentially marly sequence (clayey limestone) of the Upper Jurassic, forming the upper half of the slope, which is often steep. These marls have the particularity of being rich in silica, in the form of "chailles" (nodules resembling flint) in the first few metres, or of fine sands and silts higher up in the sequence. The soils are silty, sensitive to erosion and not very fertile.

The sequence is crowned by a level of hard limestone forming a wooded cornice at an altitude of 385 metres. This identifies and characterises the original landscape of "Corton".

The parcels delimited for the harvesting of the grapes are situated on the slopes of the "Montagne de Corton", at an altitude of between 240 metres and 350 metres. They rest indiscriminately on the limestones and the marls, with the exception of the summit cornice, which has no soil cover. The exposures are varied, ranging from the east, facing the plain, to the south and finally to the west.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

The first evidence of the existence of vines on the "Montagne de Corton" dates back to the 9th century. In 775, the Emperor CHARLEMAGNE gave vines to the collegiate church of Saulieu. This past has left traces in the place names, since there is on the "Montagne de Corton" a lieu-dit "En Charlemagne", corresponding to the Emperor's gift.

In the 12th century, the abbey of Cîteaux owned in the commune of Aloxe a fine estate of nearly 35 hectares with a grange and chapel, including vines in the "Clos de Courthon" as well as in the "Clos des Poiriers".

The Dukes of Burgundy owned a clos that would take the name "Clos du Roi" after the fall of CHARLES the BOLD. Local lordships as well as various ecclesiastical establishments, such as the cathedral chapter of Autun, the abbey of Sainte-Marguerite, the Templars and then the Order of Malta, the Bernardine nuns of the "Lieu-Dieu des Champs", the Benedictines of Saint-Seine and the abbey of Maizières, also owned vine parcels in "Corton".

From the 15th century, the so-called "Beaune" wines were distributed throughout Europe. They were the emblem of the Duchy of Burgundy at its height, and Duke PHILIP the GOOD could proclaim himself "lord of the best wines of Christendom".

Subsequently, the bourgeoisie of Beaune made its presence felt on the slopes of the "Montagne de Corton". It developed large estates that contributed to the prestige of this sector of the "Côte de Beaune". Thus, in 1622, PERNOT-VIENNOT of Beaune bought back the vines of the Cistercian estate. In the 18th century, Gabriel LE BAULT, president of the Parliament of Burgundy and owner of vines in the lieu-dit "Les Perrières", became the supplier of VOLTAIRE, who boasted of drinking "his Corton" alone, "in secret".

A négociant-éleveur trade then developed in the Burgundy region, giving the wines of Burgundy a new image and organising their wide distribution on a European scale. The "Côte de Beaune" supplied "fine wines" to the négociant houses of Beaune, which held a large share of the market.

The wines of "Corton" occupy the top of the Burgundian hierarchy. In 1862 the commune of Aloxe moreover added to its name that of its most prestigious "cru", thus becoming Aloxe-Corton, following a practice then widespread throughout the region.

The controlled designation of origin "Corton" was recognised by decree in 1937.

The vines are trained according to the usages in force in the "Côte de Beaune", with planting densities above 9,000 plants per hectare and a planting based on the chardonnay B and pinot noir N varieties. Aware of the sensitivity of the soils to erosion, producers take particular care to preserve their integrity.

It is customary to age the wines in oak casks for several months, which gives them a good aptitude for keeping, according to the characteristics of the vintage and those of the "climat".

In 2008 the vineyard covered an area of about 95 hectares, for an average annual production of nearly 3,000 hectolitres, 95 % of which were red wines.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the products

The red wines generally have a deep ruby robe. In their youth they frequently give off intense aromas of small red fruits and black berries, accompanied by complex scents that vary with the different "climats". Their body and tannic structure give them a magnificent presence on the palate and excellent persistence. A few years of keeping soften them while harmoniously enriching their aromatic range.

The white wines have a remarkable structure set off by a very fine minerality. Most often, aromas of slightly spicy white fruit, particularly expressive, evolve after a few years towards notes of honey, dried fruit and truffle.

3° – Causal interactions

The parcels delimited for the harvesting of the grapes, lying on the flanks of the hill, have particularly favourable soils, with good drainage, limited fertility and a good capacity for warming up. The clay content, combined with a relative poverty, is expressed in the red wines by a powerful tannic structure.

The advantageous climatic conditions of the site also contribute to the originality of the wines. The pinot noir N and chardonnay B varieties, indigenous Burgundian varieties, are established here in one of their favourite sites and express, in the cool climate, their full potential of finesse and elegance, in wines of remarkable longevity.

The relief of the hill and its various exposures, the geological diversity and the variety of soils that have developed favour in the wines a wide palette of nuances, which has long encouraged producers to distinguish the "climats" making up the wine-growing territory.

This palette is highlighted, according to usage, by the indication on the label of the name of the lieu-dit from which the grapes come. The long ageing of the wines, while promoting a good aptitude for keeping in bottle, helps to reinforce the expression of this diversity, perceptible on tasting.

Within the "Côte de Beaune", "Corton" is characterised by a landscape of great breadth, one of the most beautiful of the "Côte". The "Montagne de Corton", covered with vines from its foot to its summit cornice, is a privileged site, known since the early Middle Ages.

In 1855, Doctor LAVALLE, in his "Monographie sur les vins de la Côte d'Or", classed the "climat" of "Corton" in the enviable category of "vins hors ligne" (outstanding wines).

Within the Burgundy vineyard, exceptional "climats" (customary name, most often the name of a lieu-dit) such as "Corton" have emerged over the generations.

They extend over the heart of privileged situations where the soil and climate conditions are optimal. Identified and named for centuries, they receive the greatest care from producers, both in the vineyard and in the cellar.

Year after year, these "climats" give rise to the most perfect wines, which have for several centuries been placed at the top of the classification of the great wines of Burgundy.

The term "grand cru" associated with them appeared at the beginning of the 20th century, and its indication on the label is a well-established usage.

Aware of having an exceptional territory that they maintain with the greatest care, producers have developed over the generations a flattering renown for wines with an international reputation.

XI. – Transitional measures

In vine parcels in place on 31 July 2009, for the white wines, the aligoté B variety is authorised as an accessory variety, only as mixed plantings within the parcels.

The proportion of plants of this variety is limited to 15 % within each parcel.

Where the white wines are produced from parcels planted with this accessory variety, the wines are vinified by blending the grapes concerned.

XII. – Rules of presentation and labelling

1° – General provisions

Wines for which, under the terms of the present specification, the controlled designation of origin "Corton" is claimed and which are presented under the said appellation may not be declared after the harvest, offered to the public, dispatched, put up for sale or sold unless, in the harvest declaration, in advertisements, on leaflets, labels, invoices and any containers whatsoever, the aforesaid controlled designation of origin is entered.

2° – Particular provisions

a) – The name of a climat that may be associated with the controlled designation of origin is placed immediately after the name of the controlled designation of origin and printed in characters whose dimensions, both in height and in width, are not larger than those of the characters making up the name of the controlled designation of origin.

b) – The labelling of wines benefiting from the controlled designation of origin may specify the larger geographical unit "Vin de Bourgogne" or "Grand Vin de Bourgogne".

c) – The indication of the grape variety is prohibited on the labelling of wines benefiting from the controlled designation of origin.

CHAPTER II

I. – Declaration obligations

1. Claim declaration

The claim declaration is sent to the defence and management body at least fifteen days before circulation between authorised warehousekeepers and at the latest on 10 December of the year of harvest.

It indicates in particular:

- the designation claimed;

- the volume of the wine;

- the EVV or SIRET number;

- the name and address of the applicant;

- the place of storage of the wine.

It is accompanied in particular by a copy of the harvest declaration and, as the case may be, a copy of the production declaration or an extract of the stock accounts for buyers of grapes and musts.

2. Declaration prior to transaction and collections

Every operator wishing to sell in bulk a wine benefiting from the controlled designation of origin makes a transaction declaration for the lot concerned to the approved control body within time limits set in the control plan of between six and fifteen working days before any collection.

This declaration, accompanied where applicable by a copy of the purchase contract, specifies in particular:

- the identity of the operator;

- the EVV or SIRET number;

- the identification of the lot;

- the volume of the lot;

- the identification of the containers;

- the identity of the buyer.

If collections are made for volumes smaller than those set out in the transaction declaration, the operator informs the approved control body in writing.

3. Declaration of release for consumption

Every operator declares to the approved control body each lot of wine intended to be released for consumption within the meaning of Article D. 645-18-I of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code.

This declaration may also be drawn up for lots already packaged. It is made within time limits set in the control plan of between six and fifteen working days before release for consumption or before the lots concerned are dispatched from the operator's cellars.

It specifies in particular:

- the identity of the operator;

- the EVV or SIRET number;

- the identification of the lot;

- the volume of the lot;

- the lot number for wines already packaged;

- the identification of the containers for non-packaged wines.

However, making available to the approved control body the register referred to in Article D. 645-18 II of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code serves as the declaration of release for consumption, under the conditions set out in the control plan.

4. Declaration relating to the dispatch outside the national territory of a non-packaged wine

Every operator wishing to dispatch outside the national territory a non-packaged wine benefiting from the controlled designation of origin declares it to the approved control body within time limits set in the control plan of between six and fifteen working days before any dispatch.

5. Fallback declaration

Every operator carrying out a fallback of a wine benefiting from the controlled designation of origin into a more general controlled designation of origin sends the defence and management body and the

approved control body a monthly declaration at the latest on the 1st working day following the tenth day of each month.

This declaration indicates in particular:

- the identity of the operator;

- the EVV or SIRET number;

- the more general controlled designation of origin of the fallback;

- the volume concerned by the fallback;

- the vintage;

- the state of the lot concerned (bulk, bottle, hermetically sealed vacuum containers…).

The approved control body transmits without delay a copy of the monthly declaration to the approved control body for the more general controlled designation of origin concerned.

The defence and management body transmits without delay to the defence and management body of the more general controlled designation of origin concerned the list of operators who have made a monthly fallback declaration, together with a summary statement indicating:

- the more general controlled designation of origin of the fallback;

- the volume concerned by the fallback;

- the vintage(s);

- the state of the lot(s) concerned (bulk, bottle, hermetically sealed vacuum containers…).

6. Downgrading declaration

Every operator carrying out a downgrading of wines benefiting from the controlled designation of origin sends the defence and management body and the approved control body a monthly declaration within time limits set in the control plan. This declaration indicates in particular:

- the identity of the operator;

- the EVV or SIRET number;

- the volume downgraded;

- the vintage;

- the date of the downgrading.

7. Declaration of equipment for TSE

Every operator holding a concentration apparatus declares it upon purchase to the defence and management body, specifying its specifications. The defence and management body keeps an up-to-date list of operators holding such equipment and sends it each year to the services of the National Institute of Origin and Quality at the latest on 1 September.

Every operator using a service provider declares it to the defence and management body, which draws up the list of these operators and sends it each year to the services of the National Institute of Origin and Quality at the latest on 1 September.

8. Reworking of parcels

Before any development or any works liable to modify the morphology, the subsoil, the arable layer (including any addition of exogenous soil) or the elements that guarantee the integrity and sustainability of the soils of a parcel intended for the production of the controlled designation of

origin, with the exception of classic deep-ploughing works, the operator sends a declaration to the defence and management body at least four weeks before the planned start date of the works.

The defence and management body transmits, without delay, a copy of this declaration to the services of the National Institute of Origin and Quality.

II. – Keeping of registers

1. General plan of the storage and vinification places

Every vinifying operator keeps up to date and available for the approved control body a general plan of the storage and vinification places, allowing in particular the number, designation and capacity of the containers to be identified.

2. TSE register

Every operator carrying out partial concentration of musts keeps an up-to-date TSE register including in particular:

- the initial volume;

- the volume of water evaporated;

- the identification of the lot after concentration (volume and potential alcoholic strength).

CHAPTER III

I. – Main points to be checked and evaluation methods

MAIN POINTS TO BE CHECKED	EVALUATION METHODS
A – STRUCTURAL RULES	
A1 – Location of operators within the immediate proximity area	Documentary check
A2 – Belonging of the planted parcels to the delimited area	– Documentary check: up-to-date CVI parcel record; – Check in the field
A3 – Claimable production potential (grape varieties and proportion rules, monitoring of transitional measures, planting density, plant material)	– Documentary check; – Check in the field
A4 – Processing, ageing, packaging and storage facilities	
Vat capacity	– Documentary check: general plan of the storage places; – On-site check
Ageing (temperature control and length of ageing)	– Documentary check: declaration of release for consumption or bottling register; – On-site check
State of upkeep of the cellar and equipment (hygiene)	On-site check
Protected storage place and storage conditions (T °C)	On-site check
B – RULES LINKED TO THE PRODUCTION CYCLE	
B1 – Management of the vineyard	
Pruning	Check in the field

MAIN POINTS TO BE CHECKED	EVALUATION METHODS
Average maximum load per parcel	Check in the field
Cultivation and sanitary condition of the vine (sanitary condition of foliage and berries, upkeep of the soil, upkeep of the trellising)	Check in the field
B2 – Harvest, transport and ripeness of the grapes	
Ripeness of the grapes	– Documentary check: records of ripeness monitoring; – Check in the field
B3 – Processing, elaboration, ageing, packaging, storage	
Oenological practices or treatments (enrichment, prohibited practices…)	– Documentary check: declaration of equipment and TSE register, enrichment, acidification and de-acidification register; – On-site check
Stock accounts, analytical traceability	Documentary check: keeping of registers, analysis reports
B4 – Harvest declaration and claim declaration	
Missing vines	– Documentary check (keeping the list up to date); – Check in the field
Authorised yield	Documentary check: check of declarations, monitoring of authorisations granted by the INAO services after their investigation of the operator's individual request
VSI, volumes harvested in excess of the authorised yield	Documentary check: monitoring of destruction certificates
Claim declaration	– Documentary and on-site check: compliance with procedures and time limits, consistency with the harvest and production declarations; – Check of the release of products into circulation
C – CHECKS ON THE PRODUCTS	
Non-packaged wines (at transaction or collection)	Analytical and organoleptic examination
Packaged wines (before or after preparation for release for consumption)	Analytical and organoleptic examination
Non-packaged wines intended for dispatch outside the national territory	Analytical and organoleptic examination of all lots
D – PRESENTATION OF THE PRODUCTS	
Labelling	On-site check

II. – References concerning the control structure

S.A.S. ICONE Bourgogne

132/134 route de Dijon, BP 266, 21207 BEAUNE CEDEX

Tel.: (33) (0)3 80 25 09 50 – Fax: (33) (0)3 80 24 63 23 – Email: beaune@icone-sas.com

This control body is accredited in accordance with standard 45011.

Compliance with the present specification is checked by a third-party body offering guarantees of competence, impartiality and independence, on behalf of the INAO, on the basis of an approved

control plan.

The control plan recalls the self-checks carried out by operators on their own activity and the internal checks carried out under the responsibility of the defence and management body. It indicates the external checks carried out by the third-party body as well as the analytical and organoleptic examinations.

All checks are carried out by sampling. Non-packaged wines intended for dispatch outside the national territory are subject to systematic analytical and organoleptic checks.